

CASE STUDY - 10

TITLE: PRIVACY POLICY & DATA PROTECTION

By:

Name: Muthumari.E

Reg No: 2550043

Class: 2nd B. Com (Honours)

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Introduction:

Today, almost every organization collects personal information from people. This may include names, phone numbers, email addresses, bank details, and other personal information. This data is useful for businesses, but it also creates privacy and security problems.

A privacy policy explains how an organization collects, uses, stores, and protects people's personal information. It also tells people about their rights and how their information is being used.

This case study explains the importance of privacy policies, data protection, ethical practices, and proper management of personal data.

Objectives of the Unit:

The main objectives of this unit are:

- ❖ To understand the importance of privacy and data protection.
- ❖ To learn about the laws related to personal data.
- ❖ To understand the main parts of a good privacy policy.
- ❖ To know how organizations should protect people's data.
- ❖ To understand the ethical responsibilities of organizations.
- ❖ To learn how to review and improve a privacy policy.
- ❖ To understand privacy issues through practical examples.

Elements and Standards of the Code of Conduct:

A good privacy policy should have clear rules for handling personal data. Some important principles are:

- **Lawfulness and Transparency:** Data should be collected and used legally. People should know how their data is being used.
- **Purpose Limitation:** Data should be collected only for a clear and proper purpose.
- **Data Minimization:** Organizations should collect only the information they actually need.
- **Accuracy:** Personal information should be correct and updated when necessary.
- **Storage Limitation:** Data should not be stored for longer than required.
- **Security and Confidentiality:** Personal data should be protected from hackers and unauthorized people.
- **Accountability:** Organizations should take responsibility for protecting the data they collect.

These principles are followed in many data protection laws, such as the GDPR and India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

Ethics and Governance Frameworks:

Ethics means doing the right thing while handling people's personal information. Organizations should not misuse personal data just because they have access to it.

Some important parts of ethical data management are:

- **Respect for individuals:** People's privacy should be respected.
- **Good governance:** Organizations should have responsible people or teams to manage privacy and data security.
- **Risk Management:** Organizations should regularly check for privacy and security risks.
- **Stakeholder Participation:** Employees, customers, and other important people should be involved when necessary.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Privacy policies should be updated when technology and laws change.

Data Subject Rights:

People have certain rights over their personal information. These rights help them understand and control how organizations use their data.

Important rights include:

- **Right to Access:** A person can ask what personal information an organization has about them.
- **Right to Correction:** A person can ask the organization to correct wrong or incomplete information.

- **Right to Erasure:** In certain situations, a person can ask for their personal data to be deleted.
- **Right to Data Portability:** A person may be able to receive their data in a usable format and transfer it to another organization.
- **Right to Object:** A person can object to certain types of data processing, especially direct marketing.

Organizations should have a proper system for receiving and responding to these requests. Employees should also be trained to handle such requests correctly.

If an organization does not respect these rights, it may face legal problems, penalties, and loss of customer trust.

Cross-Border Data Transfers:

Today, many companies operate in different countries. Because of this, personal data may sometimes be transferred from one country to another.

Different countries have different rules for protecting personal data. Organizations must therefore make sure that data is transferred safely and legally.

Some common methods include:

- **Adequacy Decisions:** Some countries are considered to have suitable data protection rules.
- **Standard Contractual Clauses:** Companies can use legal agreements to protect data when transferring it to another country.

- **Binding Corporate Rules:** Large companies can create internal rules for safely transferring data between their offices in different countries.
- **Consent:** In some situations, a person's clear consent may allow their data to be transferred.

Organizations should know where their data is stored, who can access it, and whether the destination country provides proper protection.

Breach Response Protocols:

A data breach happens when personal information is accessed, stolen, lost, or shared without permission. For example, hackers may break into a company's database and steal customer information.

Organizations should have a proper plan to handle such situations.

Main steps include:

1. **Preparation:** Create a team and plan for handling data breaches.
2. **Detection:** Quickly identify when a security problem has happened.
3. **Containment:** Stop the problem from spreading and protect the affected systems.
4. **Notification:** Inform the required authorities and affected people according to the applicable law.
5. **Recovery:** Restore the systems and make sure they are safe again.
6. **Review:** Find out what caused the breach and take steps to prevent it from happening again.

Organizations should also keep records of data breaches and the actions taken to solve them. This helps show that the organization is taking data protection seriously.

Policy Interpretation and Governance Analysis:

Policy interpretation means understanding what a privacy policy says and what it means in practice.

Governance analysis means checking whether the organization is actually following the privacy policy properly.

Some important steps are:

- **Reading the Policy:** Check whether the policy is clear and easy to understand.
- **Checking Legal Compliance:** Compare the policy with applicable data protection laws.
- **Finding Gaps:** Identify areas where the organization is not following the policy properly.
- **Getting Feedback:** Take feedback from customers and employees.
- **Comparison:** Compare the organization's policy with good practices followed by other organizations.

This helps an organization identify problems and improve its privacy practices.

Privacy Policy Improvement Process:

- ❖ The privacy policy should be written in simple and clear language so that employees and users can understand it easily.
- ❖ The policy should clearly explain how personal data is collected, used, stored, and shared by the organisation.
- ❖ Personal information should be protected from unauthorised access, misuse, loss, or sharing.
- ❖ Employees should handle personal data responsibly and only for authorised business purposes.
- ❖ Any privacy or data protection issue should be reported to the appropriate authority without delay.
- ❖ Management should investigate privacy violations properly and take suitable action based on the situation.
- ❖ The organisation should regularly check compliance with the privacy policy and data protection rules.
- ❖ The privacy policy should be reviewed and updated regularly whenever laws, technology, or organisational requirements change.

Conclusion:

Privacy and data protection are very important in today's digital world. Organizations collect a lot of personal information, so they have a responsibility to keep it safe.

A good privacy policy helps people understand how their information is collected and used. Organizations should follow privacy laws, respect people's rights, protect data from unauthorized access, and respond properly when a data breach occurs.

By following proper privacy practices and regularly improving their policies, organizations can protect personal information, avoid legal problems, and build trust with their customers.